

Von der Leyen admits 'technical problems' with new EU airport border checks

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【要点】

- ・ EUの新しい入出国管理システム（EES）が技術的な問題を抱えており、欧州委員会委員長フォンデアライエン氏が改善に向けて加盟国と協力していることを認めた。
- ・ 航空業界はEES導入後に空港での待機時間が大幅に増加し、ピーク時には5時間に達していると報告しており、便の遅延やスタッフへの負担が増加している。
- ・ 欧州委員会は従来、EESによる影響は限定的だと主張していたが、夏期の航空利用増加に伴い問題が深刻化したため、トーンを変えて技術的課題の解決に取り組むことを表明した。
- ・ 航空業界はEESの完全停止の柔軟性を認めるよう、少なくとも7月と8月を対象として求めている。
- ・ EESは非EU国の旅行者の指紋と顔画像を登録してパスポートスタンプをデジタル化するシステムだが、導入時には多くの空港で手動データ入力が行われていた。

【メール原文】

The EU's new digital Entry/Exit System is experiencing "technical problems," European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen acknowledged on Friday

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By Tommaso Lecca · Jul 3, 2026, 6:32 PM · [View in your browser](#)

The EU's new digital Entry/Exit System is experiencing "technical problems," European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen acknowledged on Friday.

"We are working with the member states [so] that the technical problems are being solved," von der Leyen said at a press conference in Cork, Ireland.

The EES has been a subject of concern since its gradual rollout last year, but the problems have become more acute as air traffic picks up during Europe's peak summer travel season.

Airports and airlines have blamed the new border control system — which requires travelers from non-EU countries to register their biometric data — for hours-long queues, operational disruption and missed connecting flights.

"There's still quite a lot of work to do to have these technical issues solved together with the member states," von der Leyen said.

The comments mark a shift in tone from the Commission, which had downplayed disruption linked to the EES. "In most EU airports, this impact is indeed limited," Markus Lammert, the Commission's spokesperson for internal affairs, said Wednesday.

The Commission said earlier this year that registering an entry or exit typically takes about 70 seconds.

The aviation industry sees things very differently.

Since the EES became mandatory, “waiting times at border control have increased significantly, now reaching up to five hours during peak traffic periods,” airport lobby ACI Europe and airline groups IATA and Airlines for Europe wrote in an open letter to von der Leyen on Wednesday.

“These delays are impacting millions of passengers entering the Schengen Area ... At the same time, airports and airlines are experiencing growing operational disruption, including flight delays, missed connections and increasing pressure on frontline staff,” the three organizations wrote.

They urged the Commission to give countries greater flexibility “to completely suspend EES” where necessary, “at least throughout July and August.”

Under the EES, travelers from non-EU countries such as the U.K. and the U.S. must register their fingerprints and a facial image the first time they enter the bloc for a short stay.

The system is designed to combat overstays and the use of fraudulent travel documents by replacing passport stamps with a digital record. Registration can be accelerated through self-service kiosks or dedicated pre-registration apps.

However, when the system became mandatory on April 10, border officers were still manually entering data at major hubs such as Rome’s Fiumicino Airport. So far, only Sweden and Portugal have activated the apps intended to speed up passenger processing.

Several airports and ports have temporarily suspended biometric data collection during peak travel periods to ease congestion.

The EES “did not change the legal frame about rules of entering and exiting the EU; it just creates transparency about abiding to the rules,” von der Leyen said in Cork.

The Commission has defended the system by pointing to its security benefits. Between its original launch in October last year and April, “over 700 persons were identified as posing a security risk to Europe,” it said .

Irish Minister for Home Affairs Jim O’Callaghan said those figures have since risen to “approximately a thousand people,” adding that around 110 million passengers have passed through EES checks since the system’s introduction.

“It is effective in terms of protecting European Union security,” O’Callaghan said.

Mobility

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